



Comparatives and Superlatives Podcast

Gate 1 – The Departure Lounge

Welcome to Gate 1

The Departure Lounge

Goal: Confidently build any **comparison** in English and understand the **hidden logic**.

What Actually Changed?

Shakespeare wrote: **the most unkindest**

Using this on an English exam today would mean a **complete fail**.

Before comparing, we must ask:
Can it actually be **measured**?



Scales or Boxes

Scales : Like a **volume dial** on a speaker (you can turn it up or down).

Boxes : Like a **light switch** (it is just on or off).

You cannot have a “mostly on” light switch.

Navigating Scales

Example 1: “a cheap hotel”

Example 2: “a fast train”

These can be a **little cheap** or **very cheap**.

Navigating Boxes

Example 1: **"a direct flight"**

Example 2: **"a return ticket"**



You are either inside the box or outside it.

VERY

Testing the Rules

Use the **very** test to check your words.

✓ **"Very fast"** works, so **"faster"** is safe.

✗ **"Very direct"** does not work, so **"more direct"** is broken.

Maximum Capacity

Watch out for words already at their **maximum limit**.

A busy terminal is at **100% capacity**.

Say **"absolutely packed"**, never "very packed".



Creative Rule-Bending

English speakers constantly invent scales when they need them.

"More electric"
means a larger
proportion is
electrified.

"More exhausted"
bends the
maximum limit
rule.



The Grammar Crime

English naturally hates **stacking suffixes** (endings).

It makes words **clunky** and **hard to pronounce**.

“Crowded” already has an **-ed** ending.



Fixing the Stack

Do not say **crowded** — you will stumble over your tongue!

Smooth it out by using **more**.

Correct version: **more crowded**.



Solid Pieces

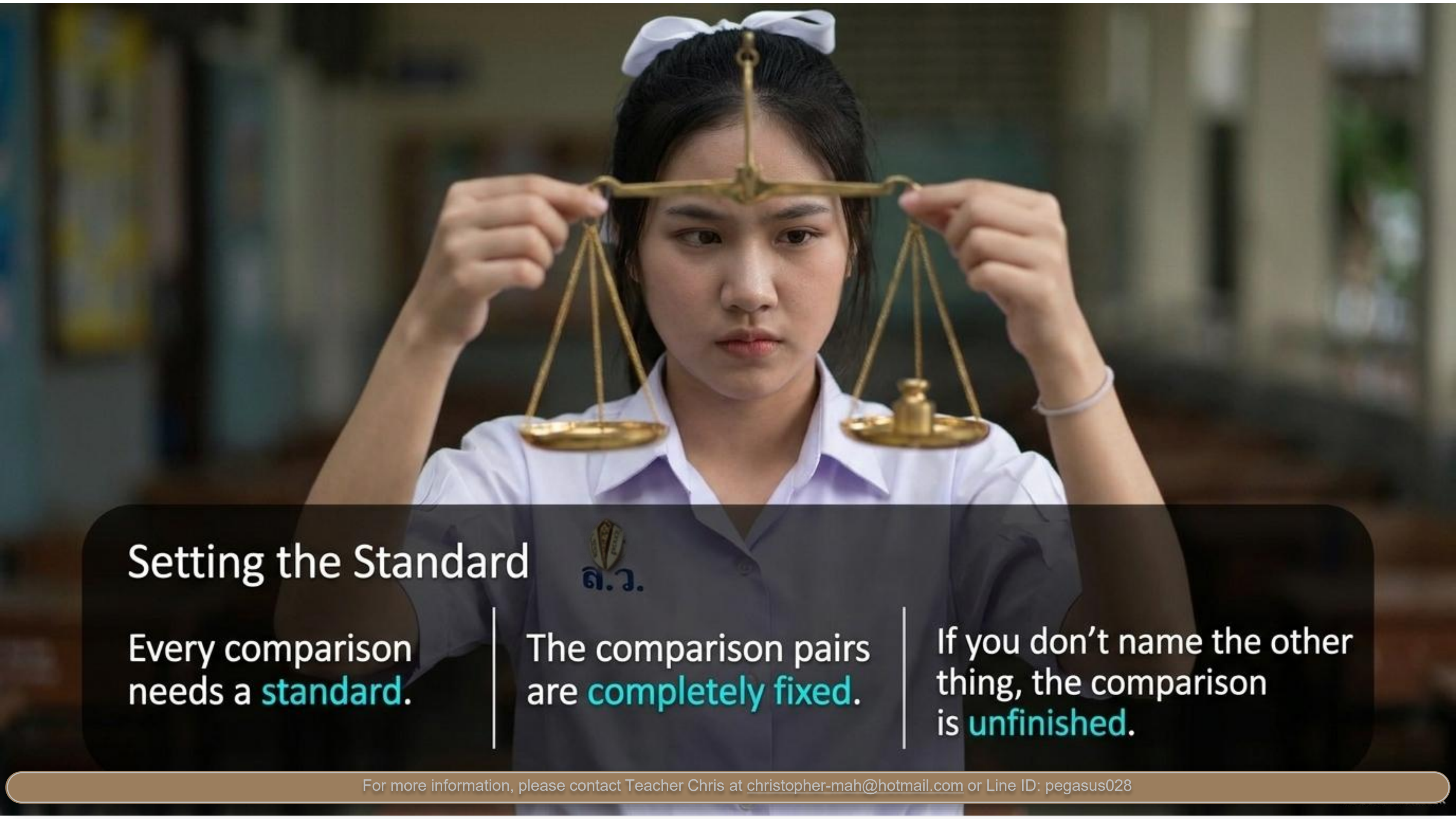
Words like "narrow" are a "single solid piece".

They do not have existing suffixes like "-ed" or "-ful".

It is perfectly safe to add "-er" to make "narrower".

Where Did the Strictness Come From?

- The ban on "double marking" was artificially invented.
- Created by "18th-century grammarians".
- They just decided the language needed to be "tidier" and more logical.

A young woman with dark hair tied back with a white bow, wearing a white school uniform shirt with a purple collar and a small crest on the left chest. She is holding a brass balance scale with both hands, looking intently at it. The background is a blurred outdoor setting.

Setting the Standard

Every comparison needs a **standard**.

The comparison pairs are **completely fixed**.

If you don't name the other thing, the comparison is **unfinished**.

Naming the Competition

Example 1:
“cheaper than
the bus”

Example 2:
“as cheap as
the bus”

You must always name what you
are comparing against.

The Ultimate Trick



Advertisers love
"unfinished comparisons"

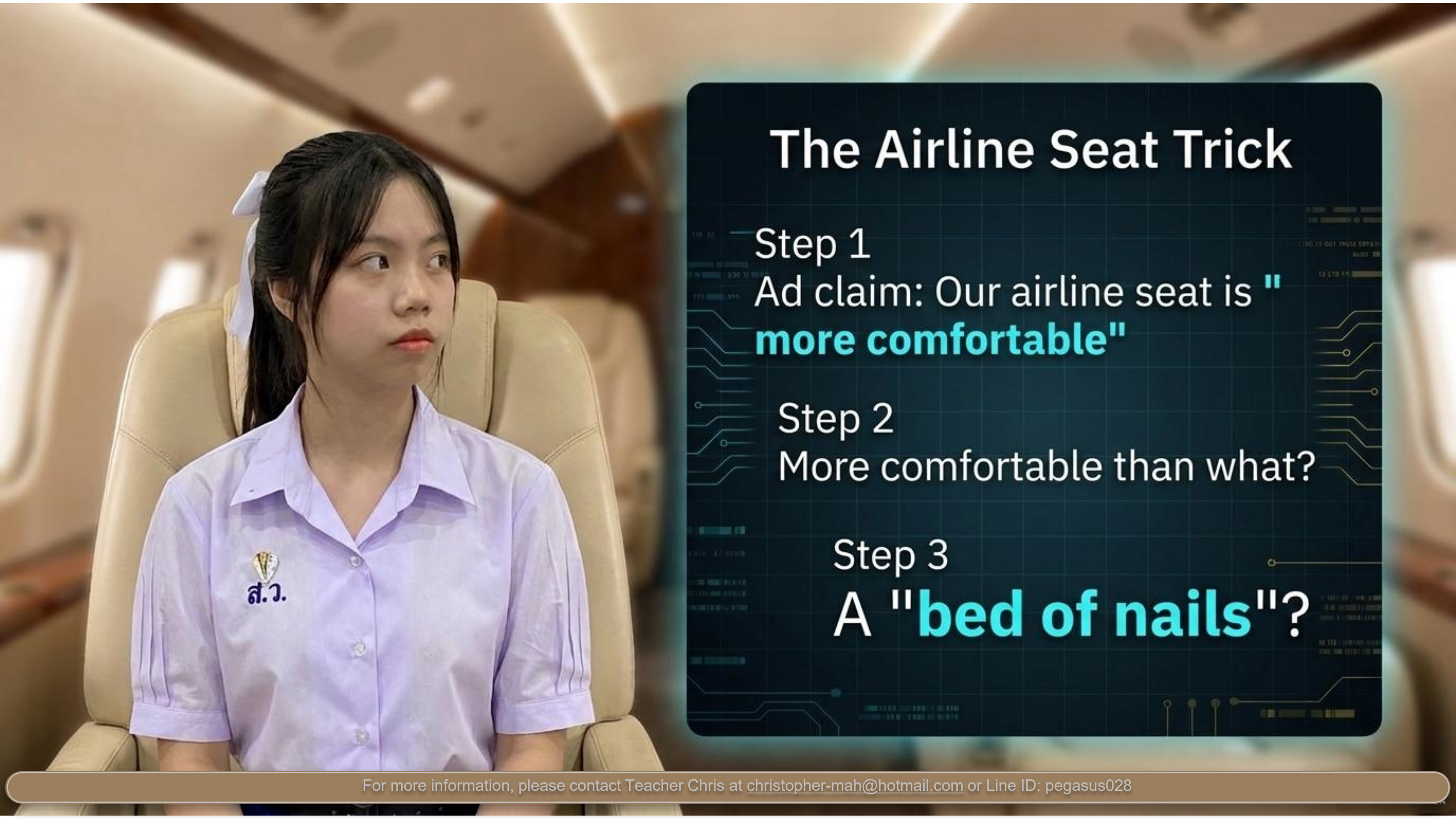


They intentionally leave
out the **"missing standard"**



This trick is used constantly
to sell products.



A young woman with dark hair tied in a ponytail with a white bow, wearing a purple short-sleeved button-down shirt with a school crest and the Thai text 'ส.ว.' on the left chest. She is sitting in a beige airplane seat, looking off to the side with a thoughtful expression. The background shows the interior of an airplane cabin.

The Airline Seat Trick

Step 1

Ad claim: Our airline seat is "**more comfortable**"

Step 2

More comfortable than what?

Step 3

A "**bed of nails**"?

Legally Safe



Because the comparison is unfinished, it **legally can't be proven wrong**.



It is a brilliant marketing strategy.



However, it is **highly deceptive** to the consumer.

Your Mission

- 1 Look around at "**English advertisements in Thailand**" this week.
- 2 Count how many billboards or commercials try to trick you.
- 3 Watch for those "**unfinished comparisons**".



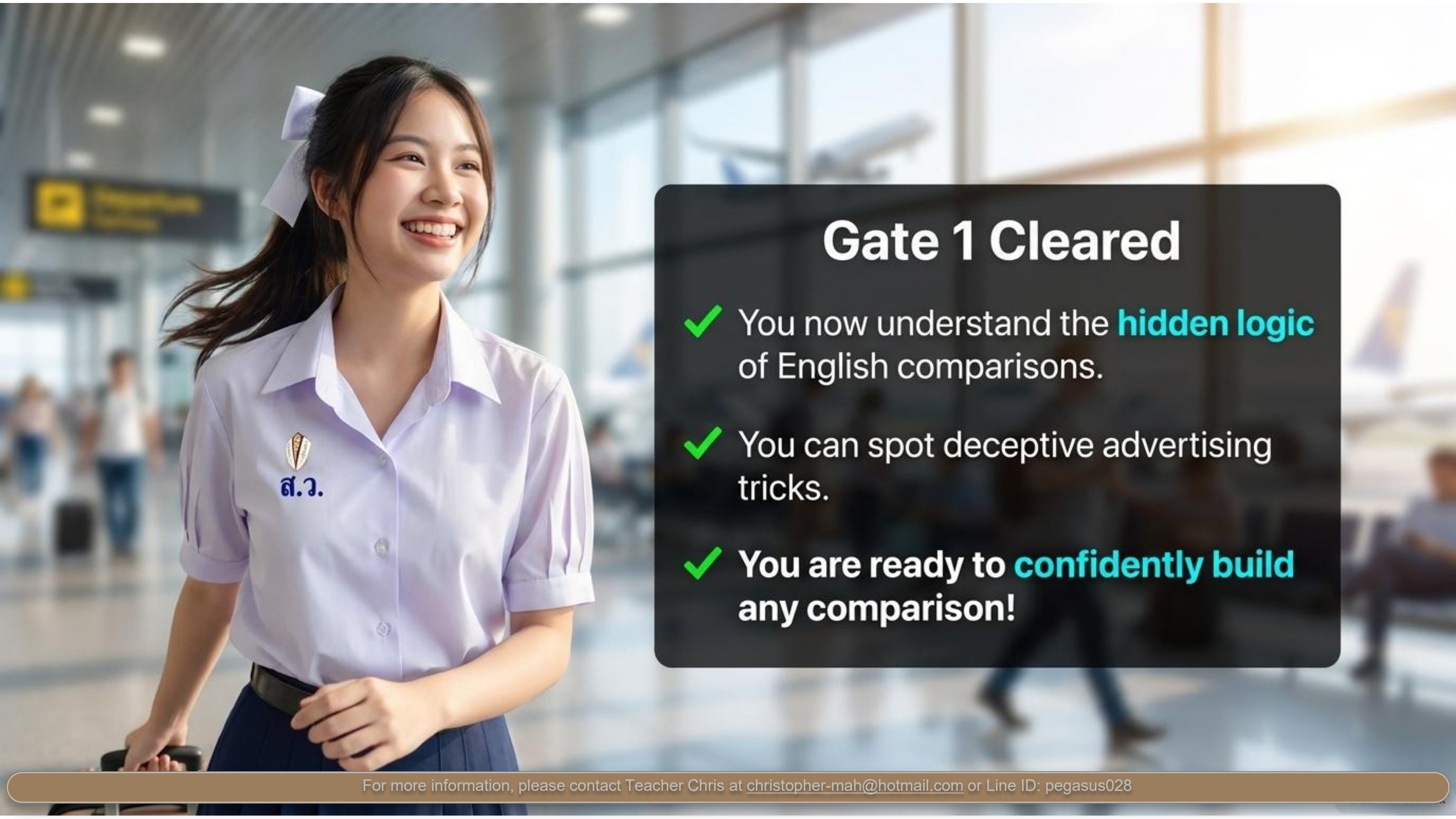
Remember This Exact Rule

Before making any comparison, ask:

Does this word have a “**scale**”?

Compared to what ?





Gate 1 Cleared

- ✓ You now understand the **hidden logic** of English comparisons.
- ✓ You can spot deceptive advertising tricks.
- ✓ You are ready to **confidently build** any comparison!